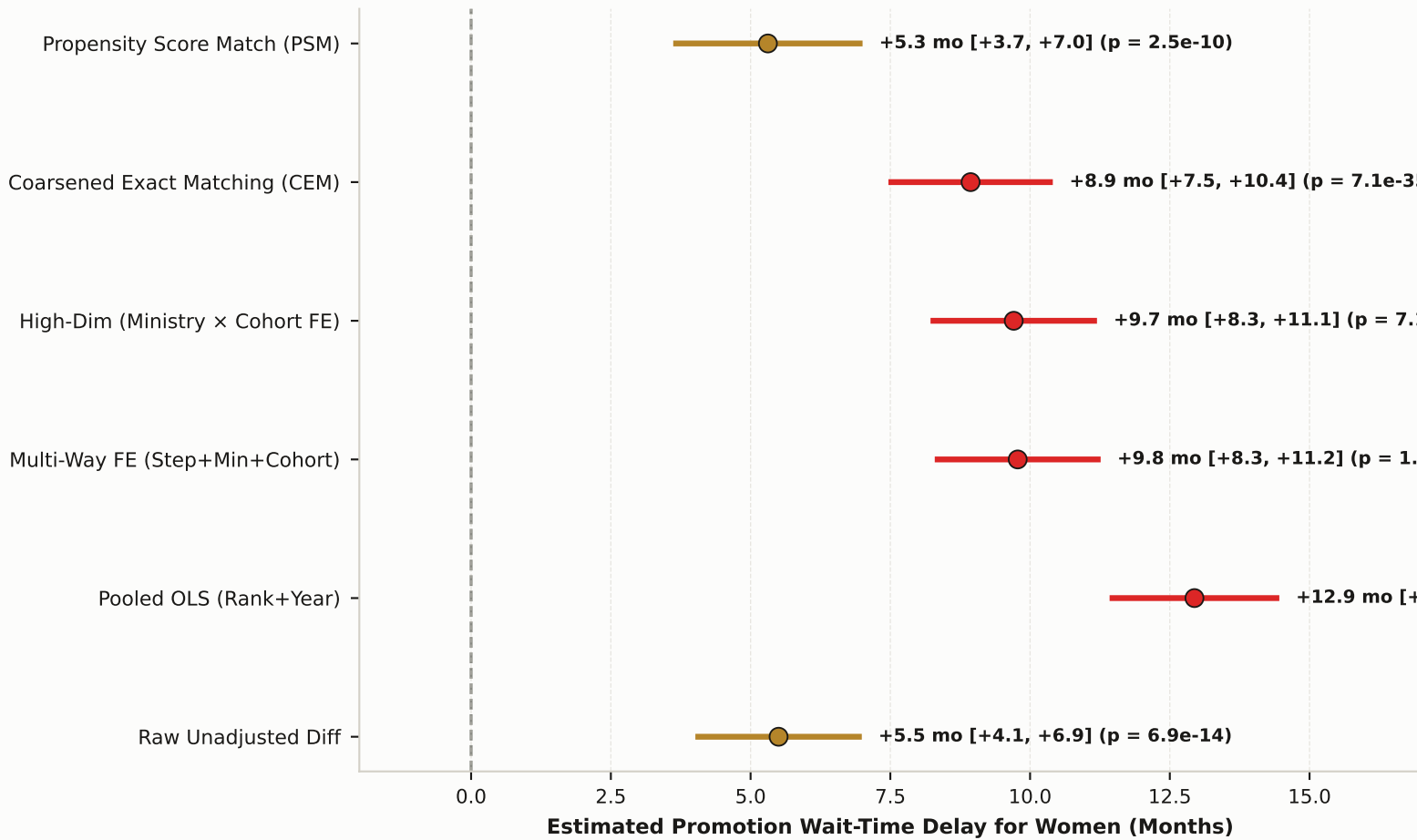
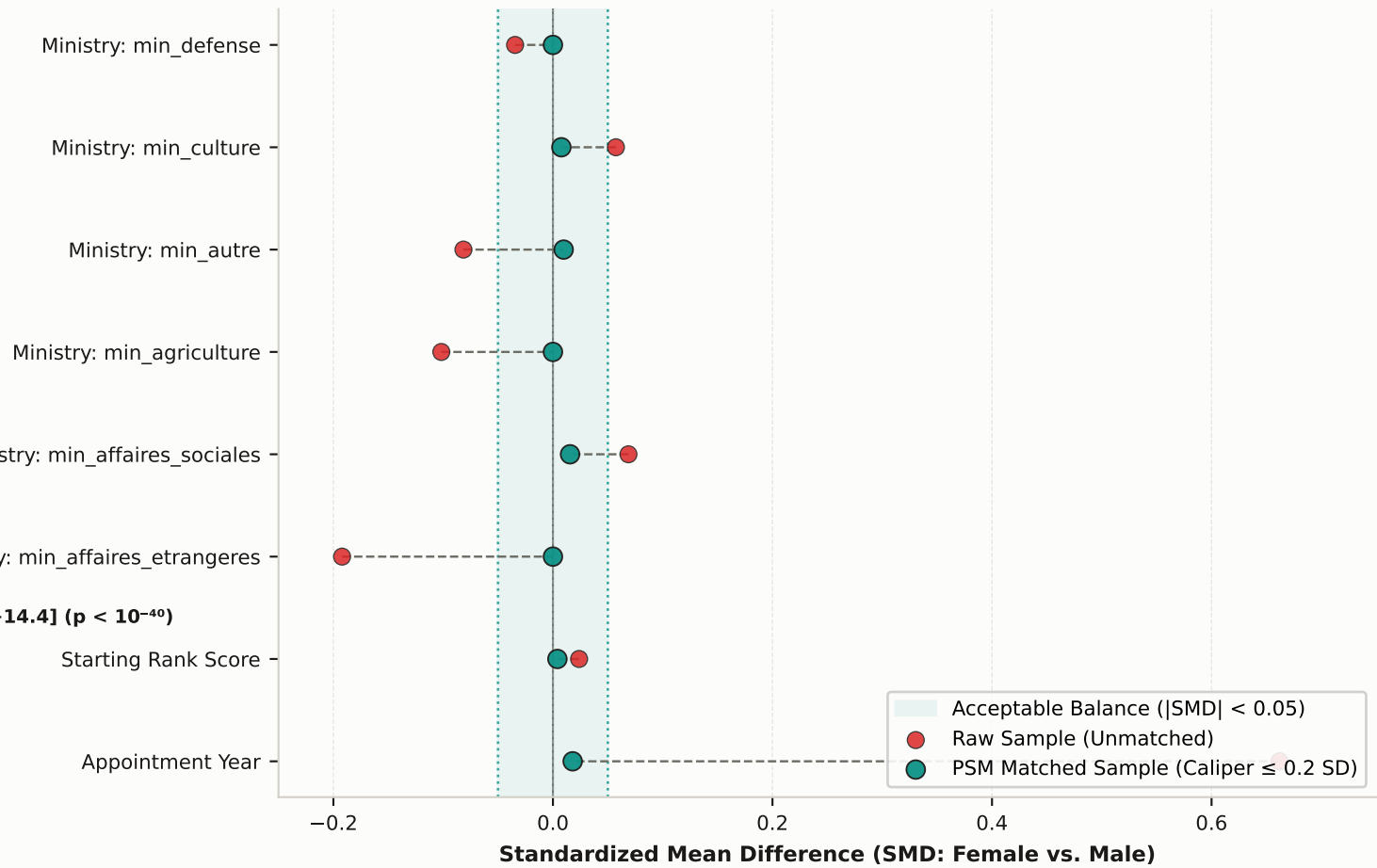


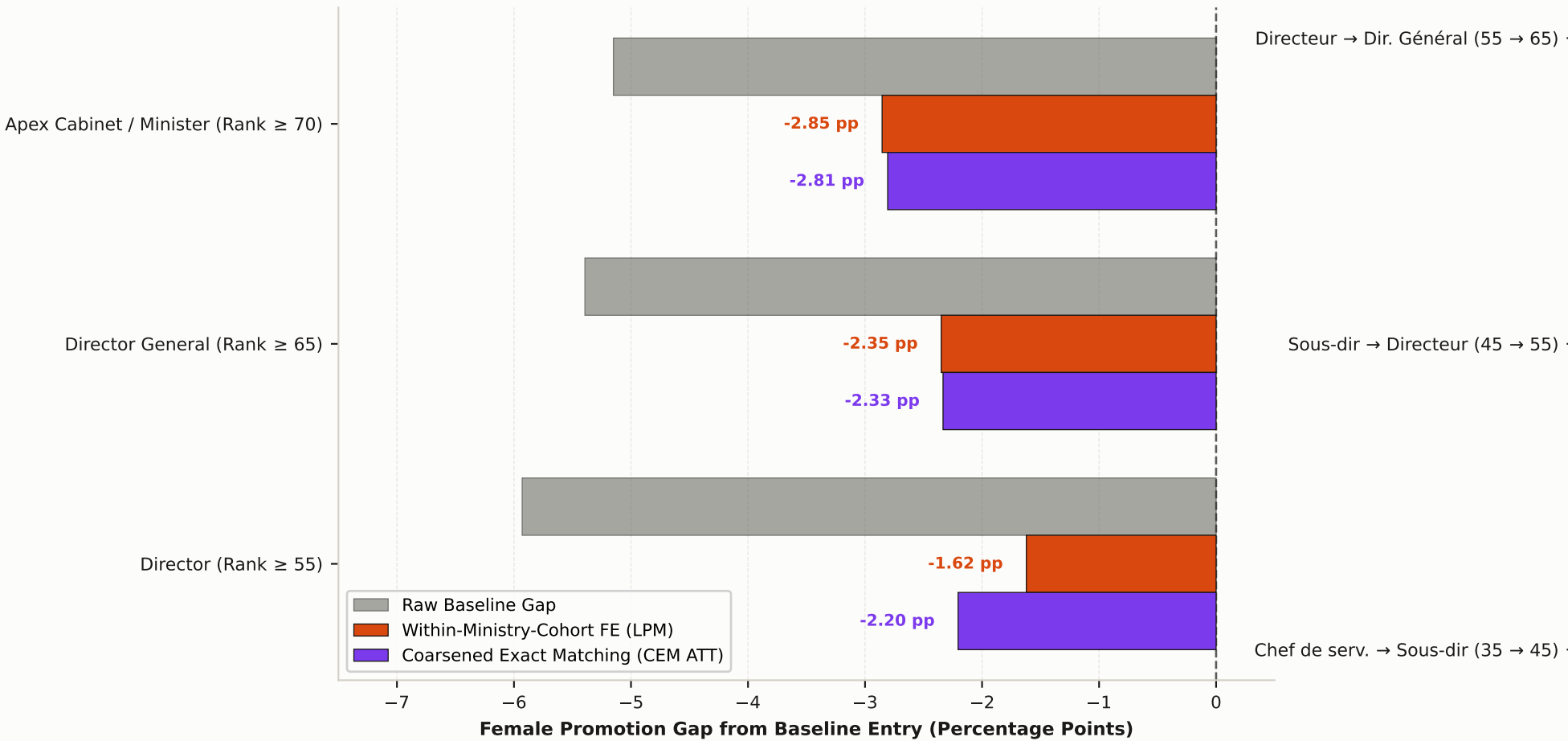
A. Sticky Floor Velocity: Comparison Across Econometric Estimators
Delay remains highly significant (+5.3 to +9.8 months) across all matching and fixed effects models



B. Covariate Balance Diagnostics (Love Plot for Propensity Score Matching)
Matching completely eliminates entry-year and ministerial portfolio confounding ($|SMD| < 0.02$)



C. Career Tournament Apex Attainment: Matched ATT vs. Multi-Way FE
Apex penalties persist identically within the same cohort and ministerial entry pools



D. Step-Specific Velocity Escalation & Patronage Robustness
Delay strictly widens up the ladder: +6.7 mo (Sous-dir) $\rightarrow$ +9.9 mo (Dir) $\rightarrow$ +12.7 mo (DG)

